

shut out by the first few folks I approached with my fact-seeking questions, I gave up. But it showed me that I needed quite a bit of polishing.

Working for my father was a bumpy ride, a bit like my first professional stock purchase—a reverse “ten bagger”: it fell from ten to one. I tell you all this only so you can see that even a kid in his twenties, without a lifetime at the top of his school class, having never attended a big-name university, and with no major accomplishments under his belt to brag on, even that kid could go on and in just a few years learn to effectively use the principles in this book. And so can you.